

How do you rebuild credibility when partners no longer want your work?

The problem wasn't that our learning could be better. Carrier partners had stopped believing it was worth giving to their employees.

- People Leadership
- Transformation Experience
- Executive-Level Scope

The organization had lost credibility.



Materials contained product errors. Visual execution was inconsistent. The quality didn't represent what you'd expect from an international brand.

And carrier partners noticed. They increasingly didn't want manufacturer-created learning because they didn't believe it would benefit their employees.



I started with one question.



“What do you need from us to get a yes?”

Then we built against their answers.

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“Tell us when we'll get it.”

→ Workback timelines, meetings, and flash reports.
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“Tell us what we're getting.”

→ Menu of materials and a recommended baseline package.
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“Let us provide feedback.”

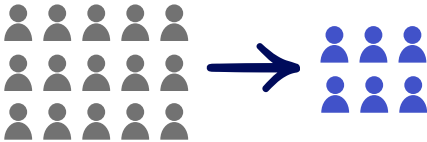
→ Structured review stages, commenting mechanisms and change logs.
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“Improve the quality.”

→ Governance, QA, and a new content-development process.

Raising the standard changed the team.

There was nearly 80% turnover over two years. That wasn't the objective. But some employees didn't have the skill required by the new standard. Others didn't want to work within the new expectations. We parted ways respectfully.



Then the market told us whether the turnaround worked.



Our channel partners successfully sold our materials into every major carrier.

Within two launches, the learning population expanded from roughly:



AT A GLANCE

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40 people
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4 direct reports
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80% turnover over two years
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90K → 192K learner reach

WHY THIS STORY

This is probably the clearest example of me choosing standards over comfort. Rebuilding credibility required changing the work, the processes, and ultimately the team — while still treating people with respect.

This story also demonstrates:

- Leading leaders
- Creative leadership
- Quality and governance
- Talent decisions
- Partner-centric leadership

IF WE TALK, ASK ME ABOUT

- What 80% turnover taught me about raising standards.
- The partner criticism I least wanted to hear.
- What someone who left the team might say about my leadership.
- How I separated resistance from useful dissent.
- The first sign culture was actually changing.
- The partner boundary I now set much earlier.



WHAT I'M PROUD OF

We won back every major carrier and expanded learner reach significantly, restoring credibility in the team and trust in our learning.



WHAT I KNOW NOW

Being responsible isn't the same as building a healthy working partnership.



IF I HAD A DO-OVER

I'd establish commitments with partners much earlier about what work they would bring to the table. We worked incredibly hard to become responsive, but I didn't create enough accountability on the other side.